Contact: Colton Wedeking - Director of Marketing & Public Relations
Phone: 325-442-5013
Email: colton.wedeking@cisco.edu

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

Cisco College Invites Community to Participate in Community Mural Project

Abilene, Texas – August 20, 2026 – The Cisco College Art Department is proud to announce a vibrant community mural project celebrating the 22nd anniversary of the Cisco College Abilene Educational Center. The mural will honor the college's two decades of service in Abilene while highlighting the city's rich heritage, diversity, and strong community spirit.

The project is being led by Jodi Frizzell, Cisco College Art Department Chair, with Abilene artist and muralist Stephanie Prosser creating the mural design. Prosser is the owner and a resident artist at 1117 Studios & Gallery, a creative studio and gallery space near downtown Abilene that supports local artists, exhibitions, workshops, and community arts experiences.

For the Cisco College project, Prosser's experience with large-scale public art and community-focused creative work makes her well suited to design a mural intended not only to commemorate an anniversary, but also to become part of the Abilene community itself.

Designed as both a public artwork and a community collaboration, the mural will visually represent the impact Cisco College has made in Abilene over the past 20 years and the college's continued integration into the broader Abilene community.

"This project is about more than creating a beautiful piece of public art," said Frizzell. "It is an opportunity to celebrate Cisco College's history in Abilene while bringing students, artists, educators, and community members together to create something they can all take pride in."

The mural is located in an open picnic area at the Abilene Educational Center. The space already serves as a gathering place for significant public and community events, making the

mural highly visible and accessible to students, employees, visitors, and community members.

Community members are invited to take part directly in the mural's creation during a community painting day on August 26 from 8 a.m. to noon.

To make participation easy and welcoming for everyone, Prosser will have paint cups prepared and sections of the mural ready for volunteers when they arrive. The experience will function much like a massive community paint-by-number, allowing participants to follow Prosser's prepared design and contribute to the finished mural one section at a time.

No prior artistic experience is needed. Volunteers simply need to select a time, grab a brush, and help bring the vision to life.

Participation will be organized in 30-minute time slots, giving community members flexibility to choose a time that works best for their schedules. The format will allow many individuals to participate throughout the morning and put their own brushstrokes into a mural celebrating Cisco College and Abilene.

Those interested in participating are encouraged to sign up in advance:

Community Mural Painting Sign-Up:
https://www.signupgenius.com/go/10C0448AEA629A2F8CF8-65097910-mural

The hands-on painting event is intended to strengthen community ownership of the project and create a lasting sense of pride in the finished mural. By inviting the public to participate, Cisco College hopes the mural will become not only a visual celebration of the Abilene Educational Center's anniversary, but also a shared community accomplishment created by many hands.

The mural project is made possible through grant funding from the **Abilene Cultural Affairs Committee, First Financial Wealth Management, and Rea Charitable Trust**. Their support has helped provide the resources necessary to bring together professional artistry, student involvement, and community participation.

By combining public art, education, and community engagement, the mural will serve as a lasting tribute to the Abilene Educational Center's first 20 years while looking ahead to its continued role in the Abilene community.

Community Painting Day

Date: August 26
Time: 8 a.m.–12 p.m.
Location: Cisco College Abilene Educational Center, outdoor picnic area, 717 E. Industrial

Blvd., Abilene
Participation: 30-minute volunteer painting sessions
Experience Required: None — all skill levels are welcome
Muralist: Stephanie Prosser, 1117 Studios & Gallery
Sign Up: https://www.signupgenius.com/go/10C0448AEA629A2F8CF8-65097910-mural

###

About Stephanie Prosser and 1117 Studios & Gallery

Stephanie Prosser is an Abilene artist and muralist whose public art, murals, and commercial work can be seen throughout the community. She owns and operates 1117 Studios & Gallery, located at 1117 Walnut Street in Abilene. The creative facility provides studio space for resident artists while also hosting exhibitions, workshops, events, and opportunities for the public to engage with local art. The studio's mission is to inspire, educate, and create while encouraging the continued growth of Abilene's arts community.

About Cisco College

Since first admitting students in 1940, Cisco College has offered programs and activities intended to encourage lifelong learning and enhance the quality of life in the communities it serves.

As a member of the Texas state system of publicly supported institutions of higher education, Cisco College maintains an open-door admissions policy and provides an array of learning, skill development and life experiences to motivate and challenge students. Classes are offered at two primary locations, Cisco and Abilene, in addition to several other off-campus sites. The College strives to maintain a student/faculty ratio which facilitates close interaction between faculty and students.

Cisco College is accredited by the Southern Association of Colleges and Schools Commission on Colleges to award Associate level degrees.